Red Rock Technical College Admissions Proposal

Oct 4, 2026

Section 1: Problems and Solutions

We propose replacing Red Rock Technical College's shared admissions spreadsheet with one central system built on Zoho. Each team will see only the information it needs, and the steps between them will be connected and automated.

As of today, the front desk, admissions advisors, testing center, support coordinators, and registrar all work from a single spreadsheet that everyone can edit. Hand-offs happen by email and phone, and important details are often lost along the way. The new system will give applicants an online application, give each team its own focused view, and send the right information to the right person at each stage.

The rest of this proposal explains each problem we found and how we will solve it, what we need from you, and what happens next. Each problem below comes from our interviews with your team and is paired with how the new system will fix it. Problem IDs match our summary documentation.

Institutional

RR.1 One shared spreadsheet that everyone can edit. All teams work from a single spreadsheet. It holds every program, cohorts, applicants, and sensitive student information that anyone can change. There’s also no drop off for previous years so it’s a massive sheet. Also, if a user has created a filtered view in the system it created that for all users.

How we'll fix it: We will use Zoho as your main system, replacing the spreadsheet with connected records for prospective students, applications, programs, and cohorts. Each role gets its own access level so people can only edit what their job requires. Everyone gets personal saved views so filtering no longer affects coworkers. Past years' records stay in the system but drop out of day-to-day views.

RR.2 Sensitive information is visible to everyone. Social Security numbers, race, gender, and disability answers are open to every user, including staff who never need them.

How we'll fix it: We will set up profile based permissions so sensitive fields are hidden from anyone whose job doesn't require them. For example, the front desk will see names, contact

information, and program details, but never Social Security numbers. We will work with you to decide exactly which fields count as sensitive.

RR.3 No clear owner when someone is out. If an advisor or coordinator goes on leave, coworkers have to dig through the spreadsheet and call students to find out where things stand. Sometimes this doesn't seem to be happening which is at a disadvantage to the institution and the student.

How we'll fix it: Every application will have an assigned owner, a visible status, and a running history of notes, emails, and calls. A contact's manager can reassign one record or a whole group in a few clicks, and the new owner can pick up where the last person left off.

RR.4 No tracking of record retention. Records must be kept for the required period, but nobody tracks when that period ends.

How we'll fix it: Each record will carry a retention date based on requirements. A scheduled report will flag records that have reached the end of their retention period.

Front Desk

FD.1 More access than the job needs. The front desk can edit everything but mainly answers questions.

How we'll fix it: The front desk will have read-only access to program, cohort, and basic applicant information.

FD.2 Answers are hard to find. Staff scroll through more than a 1,000 rows in a spreadsheet for program information, and still can't tell whether a cohort has availability or when the start dates are.

How we'll fix it: A single program screen will show every upcoming cohort with its start date, seats remaining, and waitlist size. Seat counts will update automatically as students are accepted or withdrawn, so the front desk can see availability without difficulty.

FD.3 No view of an applicant's progress. When an applicant calls, the front desk can't see where they are in the process.

How we'll fix it: Staff would be able to search by name, email, or phone and see a simple summary: contact information, program, cohort, and current application stage. Sensitive details stay hidden.

FD.4 Callers repeat themselves after being transferred. Nothing is passed to admissions when a caller is transferred, and inquiries aren't recorded anywhere.

How we'll fix it: A short inquiry form will capture the person's name, contact information, and program of interest. The academic advisor sees it before engaging, and the person automatically receives program information and a link to apply. This will also help with tracking inquiries so they can be counted in your reports.

Admissions Advisors

AA.1 Applications come in through an emailed SurveyMonkey form. Some incomplete applications still get through, and advisors chase missing documents by phone and email.

How we'll fix it: Applicants will apply through an online portal with their own login, so they can save their progress and come back. The portal shows a checklist of exactly what their chosen program needs, such as immunizations and background checks for medical programs. Applicants can't submit until every required field is filled in and every required document is uploaded.

AA.2 No shared view of application status. Advisors lose sight of applicants after the hand-off, and other teams can't see progress at all.

How we'll fix it: Each application moves through clear stages: Inquiry, Applied, Documents Pending and Testing, Ready for Review, Accepted or Waitlisted, and Enrolled. Denied will also be added to the end of the pipeline. Each team can see the stage that matters to it.

AA.3 Too much manual work. Advisors send reminder emails, call applicants several times, and track follow-ups from memory or by coloring spreadsheet rows.

How we'll fix it: The system will automate the routine steps:

- Send reminder emails when documents are missing, and log each follow-up attempt automatically.
- Mark an application inactive after a set period with no response, and reopen it if the applicant comes back.
- Check ACT/SAT scores against program requirements, and only direct applicants to the testing center if their scores don't qualify.
- Flag applicants who answer "yes" to the screening question about criminal history for advisor review. Create a follow-up task to have admissions verify the charge.
- Notify the right support coordinator automatically as soon as the checklist is complete.

AA.4 Useful data isn't being tracked. There's no record of inquiries, how long each step takes, or why applications stall.

How we'll fix it: The system will record the date each application reaches each stage, along with inquiry sources and reasons applications become inactive or are denied.

AA.5 Leadership reports are built by hand. Reports are pieced together whenever leadership asks for them.

How we'll fix it: Leadership will have a live dashboard showing applicants, acceptances, cohort fill levels, waitlists, and graduates. It can be broken down by program, cohort, or program cluster such as technology or construction.

Testing Center

TC.1 and TC.2 Scheduling is manual and offline. Students book tests by phone, email, or walking in, and it's unclear whether they receive a confirmation.

How we'll fix it: Students will book Accuplacer appointments through an online scheduling page with set times and a limit on seats per session. Testing Center coordinators will have access to edit bookings. Students can indicate that they need ADA accommodations, which alerts testing staff to reserve the quiet room. Confirmation and reminder emails will go out automatically.

TC.3 Results are passed along by email. Scores are sometimes entered incorrectly, emails don't always arrive, and results aren't kept anywhere outside Accuplacer.

How we'll fix it: Testing staff will be required to confirm a student's ID before being allowed to enter pass/fail results and scores for each section directly on the student's record. Admissions will be notified automatically, and the results will be saved within the application. The system will also track the number of attempts, so retake limits are easy to follow.

Support Coordinators

SC.1 Incomplete hand-offs. Applications reach coordinators by email, and coordinators must double-check that everything is there.

How we'll fix it: An application will only notify a coordinator's queue once every requirement is complete. Coordinators will see a checkmark for items such as immunizations and background checks, without needing to open the documents themselves.

SC.2 Progress and outcomes are tracked separately. Attendance and academic progress live in a separate spreadsheet, and outcome updates to admissions don't always happen.

How we'll fix it: Progress tracking will connect to the student's record so anyone with the right role can find it. When a coordinator records an outcome, such as graduated or withdrawn, it is recorded once and everyone who needs it is notified automatically.

SC.3 Waitlisted students are notified too late, and seats go empty. Payment deadlines and grace periods are handled case by case, and coordinators call down the waitlist by hand.

How we'll fix it: The system will keep each waitlist in order by application date. It will send accepted students automatic payment reminders before their deadline. When a seat opens, it will offer the seat to the next student with a short response deadline. Coordinators will always see who has been offered a seat and when.

SC.4 Too many editors and too much visibility. Everyone can see and edit every item in the spreadsheet including filtered views.

How we'll fix it: Coordinators will see their own programs by default, and their editing access will match their role.

SC.5 No visibility into tuition payments. Coordinators only learn a student hasn't paid when the registrar can't add them to Canvas.

How we'll fix it: When the front desk records a payment, it will show on the student's record, so coordinators and the registrar can see who has paid before the first day of class.

Registrar

RG.1 Programs, cohorts, and sessions need one owner. It isn't clear who builds program cohorts and sessions today.

How we'll fix it: We expect the registrar to own program, cohort, and session records, including the seat limit for each cohort. Those seat limits will power the availability numbers that the front desk, coordinators, and leadership see. We will confirm this with you before building it.

Section 2: What We Need From You

To build and launch the new system, we will need the following from your team.

- **A main point of contact** who can answer questions, make decisions, and bring in the right people from each team.
- **Access to your current data,** including the admissions spreadsheet, the cohort start-date spreadsheet, support coordinators' progress trackers, and your SurveyMonkey account, so we can move existing records into the new system.
- **Logins for existing systems** we will connect to or replace tools such as SurveyMonkey and your shared calendar tools. Please share these through a secure password manager rather than email.
- **Your full list of application requirements,** including the 15 to 20 items admissions tracks and any extra steps for medical programs.

- **Help classify sensitive information.** We will provide a list of every student field and form, and need your team to mark which ones are sensitive and which roles may see them. Also let us know if there is a field requirement you think we are missing.
- **Program and cohort details,** including the seat limit for each cohort, ACT/SAT and Accuplacer score requirements by program, and Accuplacer retake rules.
- **Your record retention policy,** confirm how long each type of record to be kept.
- **Answers to our open questions:**
    - Who builds program cohorts and sessions today? We expect it is the registrar.
    - How do applicants learn they need to take the Accuplacer, and do admissions check ACT/SAT scores first?
    - Is admissions notified when a student fails the Accuplacer or reaches the retake limit?
- **Weekly 30-minute check-in meetings** to review progress, test new features, and keep the project on schedule.
- **Time from each team** (front desk, admissions, testing center, support coordinators, registrar) to test the system and attend a short training before launch.

Section 3: Thank You and Next Steps

Thank you to everyone at Red Rock Technical College who took the time to walk us through their work. Your front desk, admissions, testing, and support coordinator teams were open about what's working and what isn't, and that made it possible to build a plan around your real needs. We're excited to work with you and to give your staff a system that saves them time and helps more students get into the programs they want.

Here's what happens next:

1. **Within one week,** we will meet with your main point of contact to review this proposal, answer questions, and confirm the open items in Section 2.
2. **Within two weeks,** we will begin the first stage of the project: setting up Zoho, building the program and cohort records, and configuring role-based access.
3. **Next,** we will build the online application portal and move your current applicant data into the new system. Add automation, the testing center scheduling page, waitlist management, and the leadership dashboard.
4. **Before launch,** each team will test the system and attend a short training session.

We look forward to getting started.